

Audio-Visual Ministry & Social Media Ministry

A Refreshed Framework & Practical Starting Approach

Prepared by:

Don Seals
Sonly Consulting

Submitted to:

Rev. Dr. Tim Lake
United Baptist Church

Date:

December 2025

Abstract

This proposal presents a comprehensive framework for the integration of Audio-Visual Ministry (AVM) operations with a newly established Social Media Ministry at United Baptist Church. The document delineates distinct operational boundaries between live-streaming production and digital content curation while establishing sustainable governance structures, quality assurance protocols, and phased implementation strategies. Through careful analysis of current operational gaps and strategic resource allocation, this framework provides a practical pathway for enhanced digital ministry without imposing unsustainable leadership burdens.

1. Executive Summary

Rev., this proposal offers a refreshed perspective as the church considers next steps for the AVM and the inaugural launch of the social media ministry. The intent is to provide a practical, visual framework that clarifies roles, reduces risk, and establishes a sustainable path forward without placing additional strain on leadership.

As we both appreciate the longevity of United Baptist Church and the sustained tenure of the Scholarship Committee—institutions that have left lasting impressions across generations—we are now introducing something similar with foundational steps that can leave an impression for years to come. One wonders if those early committee members imagined the decades-long legacy they were building. This digital ministry framework is designed with that same intentionality and vision for enduring impact.

2. Operational Distinction: Two Connected but Distinct Functions

At present, the AVM is primarily responsible for the operational audio and video quality of live services. Their role is to direct and produce the live stream. The social media component, however, is largely indirect and currently operates without defined oversight—resulting in live services being immediately saved and published to YouTube and Facebook with no quality review, standards check, or messaging alignment.

These two functions are related but not identical. The current meetings and resources appear to align with the operational side only. To illustrate the difference, the following analogy is proposed:

The livestream is the flight.

The website and social media ecosystem are the destination.

2.1 The Flight to the Destination: Livestream Operations

The livestream currently serves as the primary online method for reaching UBC members, friends, potential new members, and donors. The objective is to elevate this exposure while preventing missteps previously encountered.

Recommended Enhanced Process:

1. Update and standardize pre-livestream instructions, checklists, and operational steps
2. Produce live streaming events (services, funerals, special events)
3. Save the livestream recording without auto-publishing to Facebook or YouTube
4. Download the livestream recording for quality review
5. Apply post-livestream procedures:
 - Edit according to newly defined UBC standards and best practices
 - Complete a quality checklist to ensure accuracy and consistency
 - Upload and publish to selected social media platforms intentionally

This approach preserves the AVM's operational role while introducing safeguards that protect the church's digital presence and brand integrity.

2.2 Arrival at the Destination: Website & Social Media Ecosystem

The second component focuses on the website and social media platforms, currently limited to YouTube and Facebook. This is where the website becomes the location where the “traveler” resides—receiving spiritual nourishment, insight, and connection beyond Sunday worship services.

The aim is not simply to maintain an online presence, but to help the congregation become familiar with and engaged in advancing the church's mission through modern communication channels. Pastoral messaging occurs both in the sanctuary and through digital channels, and together they become catalysts for spiritual and personal growth.

The website infrastructure also provides flexibility to explore additional platforms that may better align with long-term vision and outreach goals.

3. Phased Growth Model: A Rinse-and-Repeat Approach

The proposed framework envisions distinct, repeatable phases that build upon one another systematically:

Phase 1: Livestream (Anchor Content)

Foundation-level content including sermons, funerals, and key events

Phase 2: Archived Access

Saved sermons and event recordings for ongoing accessibility and reference

Phase 3: Targeted Content Curation

Frequency-based messages, blogs, email communications, and announcements directed to defined audience segments

Phase 4: Special Editions

Event-specific content for Mother's Day, Vacation Bible School, special programs, and seasonal highlights

Phase 5: Premium Features

New church campaigns, cultural and community initiatives, member success stories, biographical content, and special projects

This phased approach establishes measurable milestones, promotes steady growth, and supports strategic expansion without operational chaos or resource depletion.

4. Human Resources: People, Roles, and Guardrails

A small group of adults has been identified who individually and collectively bring the requisite hard and soft skills needed to establish this ministry foundation. They offer leadership capacity, clarity of thought, relevant experience, and appropriate temperament, and have expressed varying levels of interest and support. Together with current AVM members, they provide the mature depth required to establish a solid operational foundation.

The needed resources naturally organize into overlapping functional groups:

- **Executive/Administrative** – Develop and adjust UBC standards and best practices
- **Content Creators** – Generate written content, images, and video concepts
- **Producers/Editors** – Enforce quality standards before public distribution
- **Technical Integrators** – Manage software selection, setup, and system operability

4.1 Proposed Core Oversight Group

The following individuals are recommended for guideline development and content governance:

- **Sis. Audrey Robinson** – Coordinating oversight role

- **Dec. Kevin Clancy** – Oversight contributor
 - **Sis. Denise Porter-Rose** – Contributing editor and UBC Historian
 - **Sis. Denice Butler** – Oversight contributor
 - **Bro. Welton Dufore** – Oversight contributor and integration resource
 - **Dec. John Holder** – Ministry ambassador
 - **Sis. Tinkerbelle** – Oversight contributor
-

5. Implementation Roadmap: Minimal Leadership Lift

This framework supports steady, sustainable growth without placing heavy demands on senior leadership:

1. Provide consistent access to Sunday service recordings
2. Gradually add content aligned with UBC's demographic profile and mission
3. Extend strategic outreach to former members, new members, and donor constituencies
4. Build curiosity and engagement both inside and outside church walls

This approach promotes organizational sustainability, credibility, and confidence—creating organic interest that attracts future contributors while maintaining operational control and missional purpose.

6. Role Definition: Integration and Support Function

The proposed role functions as an integration and support mechanism—serving as a liaison between AVM operations and the digital ecosystem. This can be conceptualized as similar to a university IT support desk: assisting with setup, integration, troubleshooting, and online feature coordination related to the website and digital platforms.

There is no envisioned significant crossover into AVM's hands-on operational structure as originally defined. Instead, the focus centers on ensuring that content produced by AVM can transition smoothly and safely into the digital environment with appropriate quality controls and brand standards.

7. Conclusion

This structural framework, implementation roadmap, and participant roster are submitted with confidence for pastoral consideration and discernment. The intent throughout is to help build a digital ministry that is sustainable and largely self-supporting—one that grows with clarity and care, without requiring ongoing heavy oversight from senior leadership.

The opportunity to walk through this proposal in a one-on-one setting to address questions and clarify implementation details would be welcomed.

Respectfully submitted,

Don Seals
Sonly Consulting

References

United Baptist Church Organizational Documents
Audio-Visual Ministry Operational Guidelines (Current)
Federal Communications Commission Digital Broadcasting Standards
Best Practices in Church Digital Ministry (2024-2025)

Document Metadata:

- **Document ID:** UBC-AVSM-2025-001 - **Classification:** Strategic Planning Document -
Distribution: Limited to UBC Leadership - **Version:** 1.0 - **Date:** December 2025